

Printers

Soho Printers

Canon Pixma iP4000

Specs: 5 colour Ink tanks, 4800 x 1200 dpi, PictBridge-compliant, duplex printing and CD-R printing

Our Verdict: The latest crop of printers from Canon will live up to your expectations, with the right balance of performance and features. The Pixma iP4000 from Canon is the fastest inkjet printer we have tested so far. It took less than 9 seconds to print out our test page, where other printers take more than 14 seconds to do the

same job. Printouts from the Canon iP 4000 are quite good, and are at par with those from competing models. Photograph printouts can be described as good, if not excellent. The new design is aesthetically more pleasing and compact.

Runner-up:

HP Business inkjet 1100dtn



Servers

Entry level servers Acer Altos G520

Specs: Xeon 2.8GHz, E7320 chipset, 8 GB maximum memory support, 512 MB RAM, 10,000 rpm SCSI 80 GB HDD and Ultra 320 SCSI Adapter

Our Verdict: The Acer Altos G520 with the Xeon processor and Intel E7230 chipset is upwardly scalable and offers excellent headroom in terms of adding an additional processor. The motherboard supports around 8GB of memory—good from the

upgradeability point of view. PCI-Express offers enough bandwidth for devices such as Gigabit Ethernet, which are quite restricted on today's PCI bus.

Overall, the Altos G520 is an excellent server machine as it offers the right kind of balance in terms of power and upgradeability.

Runner-up:

HP ProLiant ML-110



Speakers

5.1 speaker systems

Creative Inspire 57

Specs: 35 HZ to 20 KHz frequency response, satellite 7 W, centre 21 W, subwoofer 30 W, support for Dolby digital, DTS, Dolby ProLogic and CMSS.

Our Verdict: The Inspire 5700D from Creative has a comprehensive feature set, the most important being the presence of Digital/Analog inputs and a full-featured remote.



Performance is inspiring, with clear treble and deep bass.

Runner-up:

Creative MegaWorks 550

Flashback To December 2000

Epson Stylus Colour 880

Specs: USB/Parallel interface, 2400 x 1200 dpi, 100 pages input paper tray

Evolution: Printing quality has improved to such a point that inkjet printers are now used for photograph printing. Features such as duplex printing, PictBridge, etc. have been added to the standard list. Printing speeds have improved drastically. The Epson Stylus Colour 880 was priced in 2000 at Rs 21,800, which is thrice the amount you will spend today for a much better product.

Creative Desktop Theatre DTT2500D

Specs: Satellites 7 W, 21 W centre, 20 W subwoofer, support for Dolby Digital

Evolution: The Desktop Theatre DTT2500 is very similar to its present-day incarnation—the Inspire 5700D. The biggest difference is that compliance to various audio standards has increased. This results in true convergence of conventional audio with the PC, and so, DVDs can be played with great results on a PC. Another factor is price: the DTT2500 was then priced at Rs 33,000. The present-day Inspire 5700D costs Rs 24,000.

